Markdown Reader

A clean and intuitive Markdown reader with real-time preview support, dark mode toggle, and drag-and-drop file opening. Compatible with macOS and Windows desktop environments.

Features

- Real-time preview of Markdown rendered to HTML
- Dark mode toggle
- Drag-and-drop support for `.md` files (requires `tkinterdnd2`)
- Built with pure Python and Tkinter — cross-platform
- Can be bundled as a macOS app using `py2app`
- Opens preview automatically and avoids multiple browser tabs for a smoother experience

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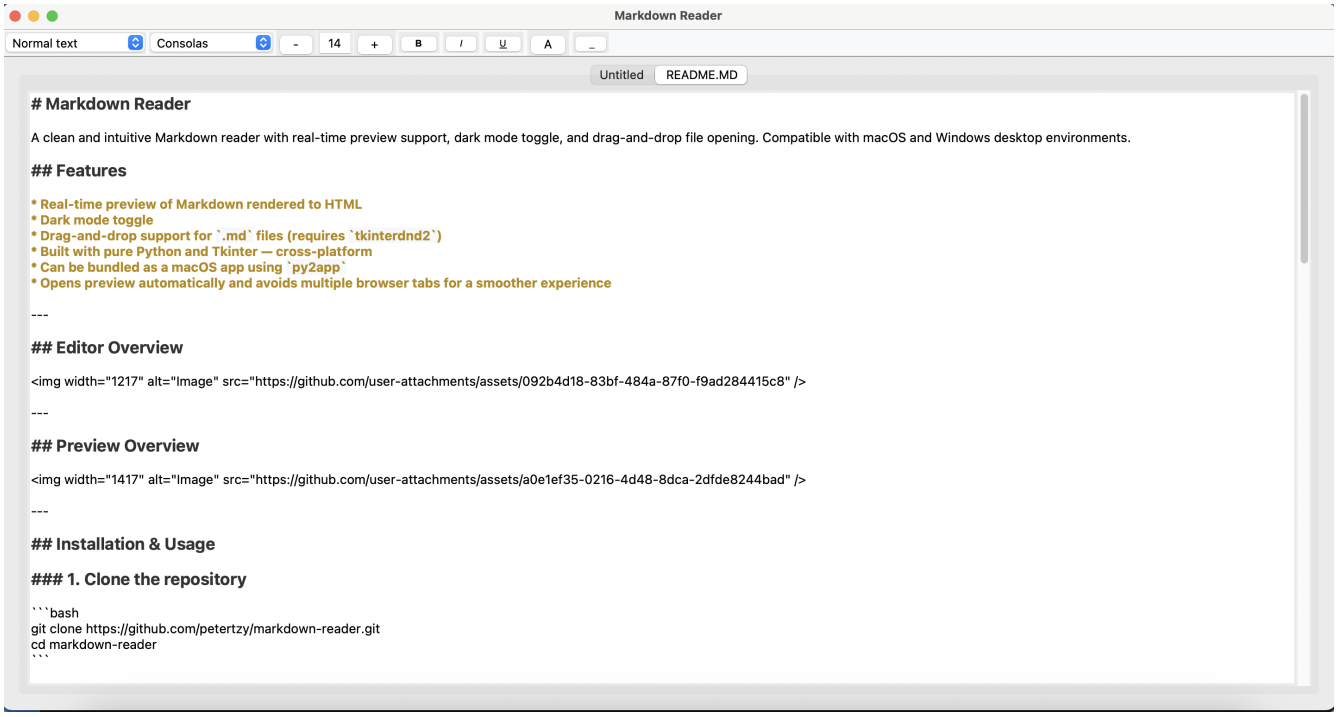
Editor Overview



Preview Overview

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Installation & Usage

1. Clone the repository

```
git clone https://github.com/petertzy/markdown-reader.git
cd markdown-reader
```

2. Create a virtual environment (recommended)

```
python -m venv venv
source venv/bin/activate  # macOS/Linux
# .\venv\Scripts\activate  # Windows (cmd/powershell)
```

3. Install dependencies

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

💡 If drag-and-drop doesn't work on macOS, consider using the tkinterDnD2 fork.

Running the Application

```
python app.py
```

How to Use

- Open File: Choose `.md` file from the “File → Open File” menu
- Drag-and-Drop: Drag `.md` files directly into the app window
- Dark Mode: Toggle via “View → Toggle Dark Mode”
- Preview: Automatically opens in your web browser, only one tab is opened per session

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Packaging as a macOS App (Optional)

To bundle this app as a `.app`, install `py2app` and create a `setup.py` script:

Build the App

```
rm -rf build dist
python setup.py py2app
```

The generated app will be located in the `dist/` folder. You can launch it by double-clicking. To use it like a regular app, move it to your Applications folder.

Exit the Virtual Environment

```
deactivate
```

Submit Changes to Git

```
git add .
git commit -m "Update"  # Replace "Update" with a meaningful commit message
git push
```

Technical Details

- GUI: `tkinter`, `tkinterdnd2`
- Markdown Engine: `markdown2`
- HTML Preview: Dynamically generated HTML opened in the default browser
- Supports drag-and-drop and live preview updates while avoiding multiple browser tabs

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Contributing

All contributions are welcome, including:

- Bug reports
- Feature suggestions
- Pull requests
- Documentation improvements